

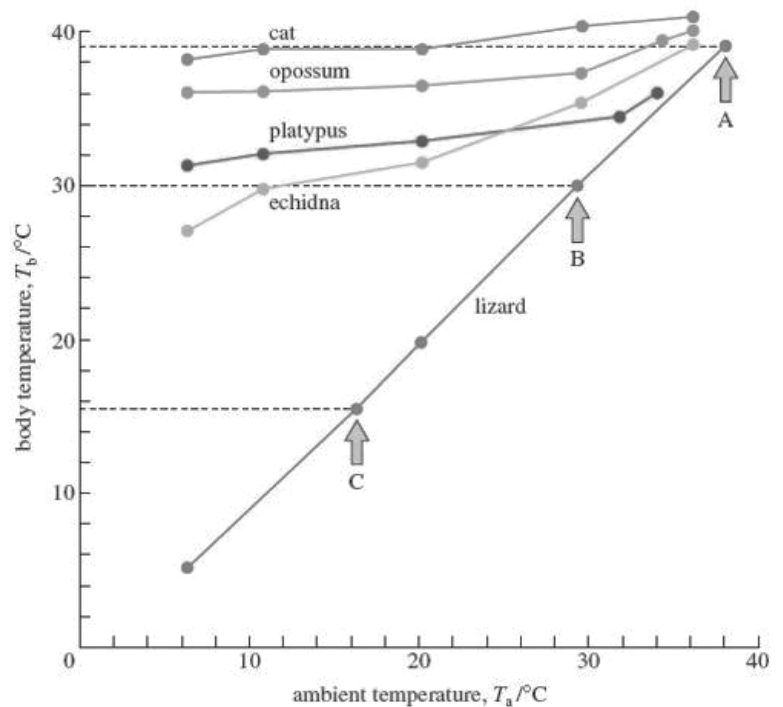
How Do Mammals Maintain Their Temperature?

Birds and mammals are **endotherms**, meaning that they produce and retain heat within their own tissues. This means that endotherms maintain a fairly constant internal environment.

Ectotherms, such as reptiles and fish, absorb heat from the environment. Their body temperatures can fluctuate with the external temperature. Maintaining systems as a constant, stable level is called **homeostasis**.

A cat is a **placental mammal**, or a type of mammal that incubates young inside their body. The opossum is a **marsupial**, a type of animal that incubates its young within a pouch. The platypus and echidna are both **monotremes**, a group of mammals that lay eggs.

This graph shows the body temperature of different animals at different ambient (outside) temperatures.



Using the information above, list 10 observations that you have made about the mammals listed above. Your list should include facts from the reading as well as observations from the graph (axis labels, trends in lines, temperature changes, etc.).

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